

Settlements & Sustainability Revision Notes

MYP 1 / GRADE 7 INDIVIDUALS AND SOCIETIES • COMPLETE QUESTION-BY-QUESTION GUIDE

Part A: Key Vocabulary (Question 1)

Here are the exact definitions you need to know for your exam, written clearly for Grade 7:

Term	Grade 7 Definition to Memorize
Settlement	A place where people build homes, live, work, and set up communities. It can be as tiny as one hut or as massive as a city.
Village	A small community in a rural area. It has a tiny population, a few homes, and limited services like a small shop or primary school.
Town	A medium-sized urban area. It is larger than a village but smaller than a city, containing shopping streets, banks, and high schools.
City	A large, densely populated urban area. It acts as a major hub with thousands of buildings, skyscrapers, universities, large hospitals, and massive transport networks.
Sustainable Settlement	A community designed to preserve its environment. It uses renewable energy, recycles waste, and protects natural resources so that future generations can live comfortably.
Ghost Town	A settlement that has been completely abandoned by its inhabitants. This often happens because of a loss of jobs, environmental natural disasters, or resource depletion.
Urban Area	A highly built-up geographic area like a town or a city where housing and infrastructure are tightly packed together.
Rural Area	An area located outside towns and cities, such as the countryside, farmlands, or forests. Houses are spread far apart, and nature dominates.

Part B: Living in a Village (Question 2)

This question asks you to contrast the realities of rural village life. Use these balanced bullet points:

Advantages (The Pros)	Disadvantages (The Cons)
• Less pollution: Clean air, lots of nature, and quiet open green spaces. • Safe community: Small population where everyone knows each other and looks out for one another. • Lower cost of living: Homes and food items are usually much cheaper than in the city.	• Fewer job opportunities: Very few businesses operate outside of basic agriculture and local trades. • Lack of services: No big hospitals, fewer secondary schools, and limited public transport. • Isolation: Far away from entertainment hubs, large malls, and airports.

Challenge Question: Which would you prefer: a village or a city? Explain why.

Model Answer Structure: "I would prefer to live in a city because it provides easy access to advanced healthcare, high-quality schools, and dynamic public transportation networks. Additionally, cities have diverse recreational

centers like museums and malls. Although cities suffer from noise and traffic, the abundance of career and educational options outweighs the quietness of a village."

Part C: Settlement Hierarchy (Questions 3 & 4)

The settlement hierarchy organizes communities by size and the number of services they provide. As you move **up** the hierarchy, the population size grows and the variety of services increases.

Question 3: Settlement Hierarchy Table

Settlement Type	Grade 7 Academic Description
Isolated Dwelling	A single house or farm building located entirely on its own in rural areas, far away from any neighbors.
Hamlet	A tiny cluster of a few houses (usually under 100 people) without any shops, services, or places of worship.
Village	A small rural settlement with a population of a few hundred to a couple thousand, offering basic services like a local post office or convenience store.
Town	An urban center with several thousand residents, a high density of shops, secondary educational systems, and regional train/bus links.
City	A major urban economic hub with hundreds of thousands of residents, complex industrial centers, and specialized medical facilities.
Conurbation	A massive continuous urban area formed when multiple expanding cities and towns grow outward and merge physically together.

Question 4: Putting Settlements in Order (Smallest to Largest)

1. Isolated Dwelling
2. Hamlet
3. Village
4. Town
5. City
6. Conurbation

Part D: Settlement Patterns (Questions 5 & 6)

This section examines how buildings are arranged spatially when viewed from an aerial perspective.

Question 5: Matching Patterns to Descriptions

- **Linear** → **Letter C:** Buildings are arranged in a straight line along a geographical corridor like a road, river, or coast.
- **Nucleated** → **Letter B:** Buildings are tightly clustered together around a central feature, such as a crossroads, marketplace, or church square.
- **Dispersed** → **Letter A:** Buildings are scattered and spread out randomly across a wide agricultural area.

Question 6: Visualizing/Drawing the Patterns

How to draw them on your exam paper tomorrow:

- **Linear:** Draw a straight line representing a road or river, then sketch square house boxes neatly lined up right next to it.
- **Nucleated:** Draw a circle or a crossroad point in the center, then draw a dense cluster of square boxes tightly touching around it.
- **Dispersed:** Draw a large empty box, then scatter 4 or 5 lonely house boxes far apart from each other with trees or farms in between.

Part E: Why Settlements Become Abandoned (Question 7)

This section outlines why people pack up and move. Understand the difference between forces that drive you out and forces that attract you.

Push Factors (Negative things that force you to LEAVE)	Pull Factors (Positive things that ATTRACT you elsewhere)
• Lack of jobs: Extreme unemployment means you cannot earn money. • Drought: No rain means crops fail, animals die, and water supplies dry up. • War: Severe conflict makes it entirely unsafe to stay in your home. • Flooding: Natural disasters repeatedly destroy housing structures. • Poor services: Terrible schools, long distances to doctors, and bad electricity networks.	• Better jobs: High salaries and plenty of career choices in businesses. • Better schools: Excellent modern education for children. • Better healthcare: Nearby hospitals with emergency rooms and doctors. • Safer environment: Low crime rates and peaceful neighborhoods. • Improved housing: Reliable electricity, modern sanitation, and clean indoor plumbing.

Part F: True or False Breakdown

Review these carefully so you don't lose quick marks on the true/false section:

1. **True (T):** A ghost town is a settlement with very few or no residents.
2. **True (T):** Cities usually have more services than villages.
3. **True (T):** Linear settlements are often found along rivers.
4. **True (T):** Sustainable settlements use resources carefully.
5. **False (F):** Every city has solved all environmental problems. (*Cities actually struggle heavily with carbon emissions and plastic pollution.*)
6. **True (T):** Urbanisation means more people moving to cities.
7. **False (F):** Villages are larger than cities. (*Cities are significantly larger than villages.*)
8. **False (F):** Dispersed settlements have a clear central point. (*Nucleated settlements have a central point; dispersed ones are scattered.*)
9. **True (T):** A hamlet is smaller than a village.
10. **True (T):** Overcrowding can be a problem in large cities.

Part G: Sustainable Settlements (Questions 8 & 9)

Question 8: Five Crucial Features of a Sustainable Settlement

1. **Renewable Energy:** Relying entirely on clean power like solar panels and wind turbines instead of burning coal.
2. **Efficient Recycling Programs:** Sorting waste systematically to prevent plastics and food matter from filling up landfills.
3. **Public Transportation Networks:** Building clean electric buses, subways, and trains to take individual gasoline cars off roads.
4. **Abundant Green Spaces:** Planting parks and community gardens to absorb carbon emissions and maintain local biodiversity.
5. **Energy-Efficient Architecture:** Designing houses insulated to conserve heating/cooling, using smart lighting systems.

Question 9: Identifying Sustainable Practices

The items you must circle are: Recycling • Renewable energy • Public transportation • Planting trees • Energy-efficient buildings.

(Do NOT circle: Wasting water or Air pollution!)

Part H: Short Answer Questions (Questions 10, 11, 12)

Question 10: What is the difference between a rural settlement and an urban settlement?

The core difference lies in the population density and primary economic activity. A **rural settlement** (like a village) has a small, spread-out population where most people work in primary industries like farming, fishing, or forestry. In contrast, an **urban settlement** (like a town or city) features high population densities living in tightly packed housing networks, with an economy centered around commercial businesses, technologies, and services.

Question 11: Why do many people move to cities?

People migrate to cities because they are attracted by strong **pull factors**. Urban centers act as economic engines offering a vast range of job options, access to advanced specialized healthcare, superior secondary or higher education schools, and high-quality infrastructure options like paved road networks and reliable electric grids.

Question 12: What problems can happen when cities become overcrowded?

Overcrowded cities face several major infrastructural crises:

- **Severe Traffic Congestion:** Gridlock on narrow road networks causes immense air pollution.
- **Housing Shortages:** Overcrowding pushes up real estate costs, forcing people into poor quality housing or slums.
- **Strain on Services:** Local schools run out of space, and emergency rooms suffer from overwhelming wait times.
- **Waste Management Failures:** Massive garbage build-up damages local ecological health.

Part I: Exam-Style Extended Response (Question 13)

This mirrors the exact structure expected of an MYP 1 student to score top marks in Criteria A and C. Notice how first-person phrases are excluded to maintain an academic voice:

Choosing an optimal residential location requires a careful evaluation of sustainability and infrastructure. A highly sustainable city located in a temperate coastal region serves as an ideal settlement type. Coastal urban zones offer vital geographic advantages, such as accessible shipping channels and natural wind currents that can be captured to generate clean wind energy. Important features of this settlement include a zero-waste public recycling program, extensive electric light-rail networks, and zoning laws that safeguard urban parks. These interconnected systems are essential because they drastically cut down carbon output while maintaining high living standards for all residents. Therefore, a modern, eco-friendly urban space provides the best balance between economic development and environmental protection.